

MOBILE Powerhouse

Laptops are no longer expensive executive toys; they are essential business tools. Find out which one suits your needs the best

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Mobile computing is redefining the way we do business, and corporates are only too happy to equip mobile workers with notebooks—it is a great business productivity tool. The importance for mobile computing stems from the need for access to critical data wherever and whenever an employee needs it. With access to data round the clock, the 9-to-5 time barrier is no longer valid, and ensures work happens outside office and past office hours.

Notebooks are favourites among marketing and sales people. Coupled with a CDMA connection that offers data services, one can access e-mail round the clock and keep in touch with clients. Wi-Fi capabilities keep you connected when you travel across the globe; a Bluetooth

adapter lets you synchronise your contact data across all your devices; a Firewire port lets you unload pictures from your digital camera at will. Besides, who likes to be away from a computer for long!

The recent fall in the prices has thrown up obvious advantages of using laptops, including time saved, efficiency, etc.

Whether you are a CEO or a sales manager looking to empower your sales force with the right mobility tools, or an individual looking for a notebook for business enhancement, you will find something here that you can use.

We tested 43 popular notebooks, classifying them into five categories—Budget, Workhorse, Lifestyle, Desktop replacements and Ultra-portables. Apple notebooks formed a separate category by themselves. You may see the detailed features and performance

